

Thomas Haakon Grüner-Hegge

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Portfolios

Artstation: <https://www.artstation.com/hawkunamatata>

Github: <https://github.com/HawkunaMatata>

Personal Profile

Experience with C++ and C# gameplay programming in Unreal Engine and Unity. I am hard working and take pride in producing high-quality results. I am passionate about programming fun gameplay experiences and seek work where I will have the opportunity to apply and develop my programming skills and gain industry experience.

Higher-Level Education

Video Game Art & Design | Royal Holloway University | 2022-2025

- Achieved **1st Class Honours**
- Developed skills in coding **C# and C++** and environment design in game engines like **Unity** and **Unreal**, as well as storytelling, 3D modelling, texturing, rigging, and animation using Maya, Substance Painter, and ZBrush.
- Created multiple game vertical slices across a wide range of genres, demos available on my portfolios.

Work Experience

Communications and Marketing Officer | Ringway Hounslow Highways | 2019-2022

- Managed relations and professional communications with Councillors, Members of Parliament, and other key stakeholders and community groups.
- Coordinated multiple cross-disciplinary teams for various projects and to meet performance targets.
- Organised and lead public events ranging from presentations at schools to community litter picks.

Intern in Chartering | Avance Gas | September – December 2016

- Tracked movements of VLGC ships chartered throughout the industry.
- Aided in the chartering and operations of Avance Gas fleet of 14 VLGCs.

Recent Projects

“Codename: Druid Action” - Ongoing

- Open-world Action RPG inspired by Skyrim and Elden Ring, with a focus on making engaging, responsive gameplay with dodging, parrying, and challenging enemies.
- Created in Unreal Engine 5.4 using primarily C++.
- Ongoing passion project.

“Dungeons & Discord” - 2025

- Strategic turn-based RPG inspired by Fire Emblem and Disgaea.
- Complex mechanics incorporating elements of D&D and story exploring themes of mental health, featuring a group of friends trapped in a D&D game to confront their personal demons.
- Created in Unreal Engine 5.4 using **blueprints** for prototyping with elements in C++.

- Year-long project in final year at Uni, equivalent to thesis or dissertation, achieved a **1st**.

“Definition of Insanity” - 2025

- First-person horror game inspired by Resident Evil and Silent Hill P.T.
- Created in Unreal Engine 5.4 using **blueprints** first and later converted into C++ for practice.
- Inspired by theme ‘Loops and Echoes’, game explores researched elements of psychosis.

“For King or Country” - 2024

- Comedic Visual Novel/Management game inspired by theme ‘Imagine Utopia’.
- Created in Unity using C# and Ink script plugin for dialogue branches.

Career Related Skills and Hobbies

- Fluent in English. Knowledgeable in Mandarin, Spanish, French, Dutch and Norwegian.
- Coding experience with C# in Unity and C++ in Unreal Engine as well as p5.js, I am always following new courses and tutorials to expand my coding skills.
- Strong with math and logic (Gold Award from UK Mathematics Trust).
- Interests include programming, drumming, tennis, reading, and video games.
- Permanent residency and right to work in the UK with Norwegian and American passports.
- I hold a clean UK driver’s licence.

References available upon request